I'm presuming you already know C# or a similar object-oriented language or that you are capable of learning C# while also learning about Razor Pages. Finally, I'm proceeding on the premise that you understand the basics of relational databases. I mention all of this because I don't cover any of these topics in detail within this book, although I might treat you to the odd refresher where I think it helps to provide context.

Still with me? Good! Let's go!

1.1 What is Razor Pages?

Razor Pages is a server-side, cross-platform, open source web development framework from Microsoft that enables you to use your existing knowledge of HTML, CSS, and JavaScript together with the C# language to build modern, page-focused web applications. Now, that's a bit of a mouthful, so let's break it down a bit.

1.1.1 Web development frameworks

First, let's look at what a web development framework is and why you might need one. Figure 1.1 shows the home page of this book's publisher's website: Manning.com.